Christy Sanchez · Western Governors University

A hospital's nurses were leaving. Could a well-being program help?

01

BUSINESS PROBLEM

Nurses were leaving faster than any other professional role.

12-hour shifts, overtime and stress were the main reasons.

02

HOSPITAL PROGRAM

The hospital launched a voluntary well-being program.

Monthly activities with a trainer, massage therapist and yoga instructor, plus a $50 quarterly bonus.

03

FUNDING DECISION

Leaders must decide whether to fund it for five more years.

?

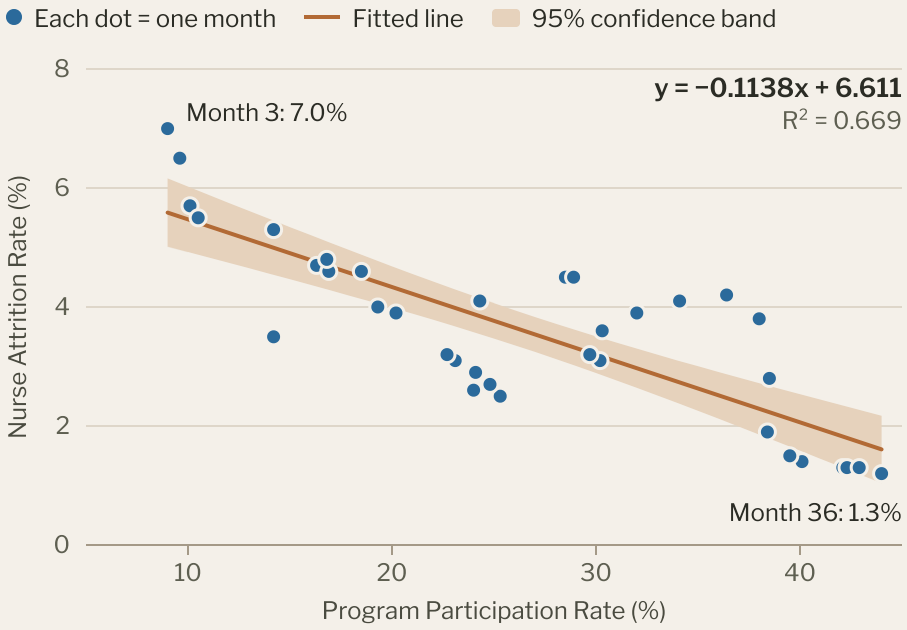
RESEARCH QUESTION

Is nurse participation linked to lower nurse attrition over 36 months?

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As well-being program participation rose, nurse attrition fell.

More participation, less attrition



67%
of the variation in attrition explained (R^2 = 0.669)

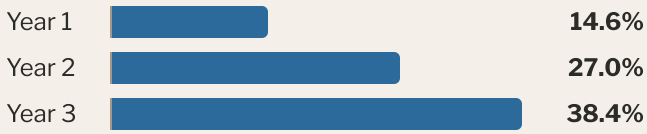
1 fewer
nurse leaves (per 100) for every 10 more who join

p < 0.001
far below 0.05: very unlikely to be chance

36
months of data, one observation per month

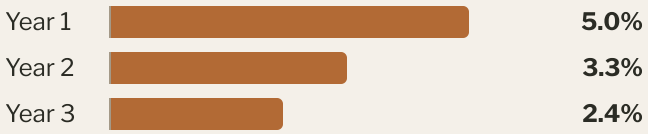
Participation more than doubled

Yearly average of the monthly rates



Attrition more than halved

Yearly average of the monthly rates



KEEP IN MIND

One variable can't tell the whole story

Shows association, not proof of cause. Other likely drivers:

- Understaffing
- Low salaries
- Bad management

Next step: surveys and exit interviews.

RECOMMENDATION

Continue investing in the program, and expand it.

01 Improve the program

02 Market it to staff to raise awareness

03 Run a multiple regression on other drivers